

Postmortem INC-7157: shipping-api retry storm after a partial outage

Date: August 2026. Duration: 128 minutes. Severity: SEV2.

Summary

Customers saw errors from shipping-api for 128 minutes. The trigger was retry storm after a partial outage.

Timeline

09:12 alert fired. 09:20 incident declared. 09:40 mitigation applied.

Root cause

A change merged two days earlier removed a safety limit, so retry storm after a partial outage was able to build up unnoticed until peak traffic. Monitoring did not alert early because the threshold was set for the old traffic pattern.

Contributing factors

- The runbook pointed to a dashboard that had been renamed.
- The canary stage was skipped for a config-only change.

Action items

- AI-334: restore the safety limit and add a regression test.
- AI-941: update the alert threshold to the new traffic pattern.
- AI-132: never skip the canary, including for config changes.